

Acceptable Use Policy

Langate Group

Purpose

This policy defines the acceptable use of end-user computing devices and technology. It also ensures employees and contractors understand data sensitivity, best practices, and potential consequences of non-compliance.

Policy

Langate Group policy requires that:

- Background verification checks on all candidates for employees and contractors should be carried out in accordance with relevant laws, regulations, and ethics and proportional to the business requirements, the classification of the information to be accessed, and the perceived risk.
 - The following mandatory background checks will be conducted before hiring employees, contractors, or third-party users:
 - **Identity Verification** (e.g., passport, government ID, tax ID)
 - **Employment History Verification** (e.g., previous employers, LinkedIn, Glassdoor)
 - **Social Media Review** (e.g., Instagram, Telegram, other relevant platforms)
 - **Education Verification** (e.g., academic diplomas, certifications)
 - **Professional Certification Verification**
 - For roles with access to confidential data, the following **additional** checks may be required:
 - **Criminal Background Checks**
 - **Character Reference Checks** (from previous employer and/or personal reference)
- The Background Check process may be repeated in case of a change in the employee/contractor's position in the company and/or access level.
- Employees, contractors, and third-party users must agree to and sign the terms and conditions of their contract or agreement and comply with the Acceptable Use Policy.
- New employees, contractors, and third-party users must complete an onboarding process that includes:
 - Familiarization with Langate's systems, security requirements, and procedures.
 - Signing an agreement acknowledging acceptable use policies.
 - Ongoing security awareness training, subject to periodic audits.
- The offboarding process includes:
 - Reaffirming post-employment obligations regarding data and security
 - Removing all access to Langate's systems
 - Ensuring the return of all company-owned assets
- Employees, contractors, and third-party users **must not** share corporate data via unauthorized digital communications (e.g., personal email, social media, etc).
- A list of prohibited activities will be maintained and provided during onboarding.
- Employees, contractors, and third-party users suspected of committing security breaches will be subject to a disciplinary process. Multiple factors, such as whether this was a first offense, training, business contracts, etc., will be considered when deciding the response. Langate Group reserves the right to terminate employees, contractors, and third-party users for misconduct or non-compliance with the Acceptable Use Policy.

Procedures

Langate Group requires all employees, contractors, and third-party users to comply with the following Acceptable Use requirements and procedures:

- When operating at non-Langate office locations, all employees, contractors, and third-party users are considered remote users and must, therefore, follow all system access controls and procedures for remote access.
- The use of Langate's computing systems is subject to monitoring by Langate Group IT and/or Security teams.
- Employees, contractors, and third-party users may not leave computing devices (including laptops and smart devices) used for business purposes, including company-provided and BYOD (personal devices of employees, contractors, and third-party users with access to information necessary to perform their work), unattended in public.
- Device encryption must be enabled for all devices accessing company data, such as whole-disk encryption for all laptops and complex passcodes for mobile phones/tablets.
- All email messages containing sensitive or confidential data must be encrypted.
- Sensitive or classified information must not be posted in public forums or chat rooms. If technical support requires sharing data, all sensitive details must be sanitized.
- All data storage devices and media must be managed according to the Langate Group Data Classification specifications and Data Handling procedures.
- Photocopiers and other reproduction equipment may be used only by authorized users.
- Media containing sensitive/classified information should be removed from printers immediately.
- The PIN code function should be used on printers with such capability, so the originators are the only ones who can print out their documents and only when physically present at the printer.

Protection Against Malware

Langate Group protects against malware through malware detection and repair software, information security awareness, appropriate system access, and change management controls. This includes:

- Restrictions on Software Installation
 - Only legal, approved software with a valid license installed through a pre-approved application store will be used.
 - The principle of least privilege will be applied, where only users who have been granted certain privileges may install software.
 - Langate Group will identify what types of software installations are permitted or prohibited.
- Anti-Malware Protection & Monitoring
 - Anti-malware or equivalent protection and monitoring tools are enabled and regularly updated on all endpoint systems that may be affected by malware, including workstations, laptops, and servers.
 - Application allowlisting is used to prevent unauthorized software installations.
 - Website blocklisting is used to restrict access to known or suspected malicious sites.
 - The company uses proactive security measures to reduce vulnerabilities that malware could exploit.
 - IT teams conduct regular system audits to detect unauthorized files or modifications; the presence of any unapproved files or unauthorized amendments will be formally investigated.
- Malware Scanning Procedures
 - Langate Group performs routine malware scans on:
 - Files received over networks or via storage media before use.
 - Email attachments and downloads at multiple security points (email servers, desktop computers, and network entry points).
 - Web pages and online content to prevent drive-by infections.
- Malware Defense Strategies
 - Malware detection and repair tools are configured based on risk assessments, with considerations

for:

- Evasive malware tactics, such as encrypted file payloads and obfuscated transmissions.
 - Protection against malware introduction during maintenance and emergency procedures.
 - A controlled process for approving temporary or permanent exceptions to malware defenses, with documented justification and review dates.
- Incident Response & Recovery
 - Langate has established clear procedures for reporting, mitigating, and recovering from malware incidents.
 - Employees and IT staff receive ongoing training on malware threats and response protocols as well as methods to differentiate between hoaxes and actual malware.
 - Business continuity plans include data backup and recovery procedures to minimize malware impact.
 - IT teams subscribe to trusted security sources to stay updated on emerging threats.
- Additional Preventive Measures
 - USB ports remain disabled where possible to prevent unauthorized device connections.
 - Writable media (e.g., USB drives, external hard drives) is restricted unless explicitly approved.
 - Only read-only media from legitimate commercial sources and allowlisted software is permitted.
 - Critical systems may be isolated from general networks to prevent catastrophic malware impacts.

Policy version history

 Policy details

Policy name	Renewal date
Acceptable Use Policy	September 26, 2026
Description	
The Acceptable Use Policy specifies acceptable use of end-user computing devices and technology.	

 Version history

Version 1					
Creation date	Approval date	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
June 20, 2024	March 18, 2025	March 18, 2025	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach
Version 2					
Explanation of changes					
Added point about repeating the Background Check process					
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April 2, 2025	April 2, 2025	April 2, 2025	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach
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Creation date	Approval date required	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
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Version 2.3

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May 6, 2025	No approval required	May 6, 2025	Eugene Skubach	-	Eugene Skubach

Version 2.4

Explanation of changes

'Revision History' section has been removed.

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September 26, 2025	No approval required	September 26, 2025	Eugene Skubach	-	Eugene Skubach
